

It is easy to get started

HTML5 is here to make your life easier and builds on the success of HTML4. Moving to HTML5 can be as simple as changing your `<doctype>`. The doctype should already be on the first line of every HTML page. Previous versions of HTML defined a lot of doctypes, and choosing the right one could be tricky. Compare, for example, the following HTML4 doctypes:

```
<!DOCTYPE HTML PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD HTML 4.01 Transitional//
EN" "http://www.w3.org/TR/html4/loose.dtd">
```

Definitely, not the easiest thing to remember and there are over ten variations of this markup! HTML5 solves this problem by defining only one doctype: `<!DOCTYPE html>` Now that's a doctype you might just remember. Upgrading to the HTML5 doctype won't break your existing markup, because all the tags defined in HTML 4 are still supported in HTML5. But it will allow you to use — and validate — new semantic elements such as `<article>`, `<section>`, `<header>`, and `<footer>`.

No escaping it

There's no way you'll be able to escape HTML5! Although it has been around for some time now, HTML5 has gained recent momentum due to a strong push from multiple vendors, including Microsoft, Apple and Google. In fact, Apple issued a public letter titled "Thoughts on Flash", where it concluded that with the development of HTML5, Adobe Flash is no longer necessary to watch video or consume any kind of web content. Definitely, HTML5 is here to stay.

History

Tim Berners-Lee invented the world wide web! Tim created the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C). Its mission was to lead the world wide web to its full potential by developing protocols and guidelines that ensure long-term growth for the web. In December 1999, HTML 4.01 was published. After this, the people who ran the W3C declared that it would be difficult to extend HTML 4 and they gave up on it for the next ten years!

Turns out that web developers got busy trying to bridge the gaps in HTML5 by rolling out custom controls plug-ins and libraries. And finally, key browser vendors such as Microsoft, Google, Mozilla and Apple got together to develop these further, finally ending up under the W3C HTML working group.